

# CSCI E-102 Econometrics and Causal Inference with R

Harvard Extension School

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Spring 2026  
Lecture 7

## 1 Multivariate Linear Regression Model (Continued)

- Multivariate Central Limit Theorem (CLT)
- Asymptotic Normality of OLS Estimator in Multivariate Regression
  - Large Sample Distribution of  $\hat{\beta}$
  - Heteroskedasticity-robust Standard Errors
  - Confidence Intervals for Predicted Effects
  - Joint Hypotheses

## 2 Nonlinear Regression Functions

- Regression Functions Linear in Parameters
  - Assumptions
  - Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms
  - Interactions

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# Multivariate Central Limit Theorem (CLT)

## Thm. (Multivariate CLT)

Let  $W_1, W_2, W_3, \dots$  be a sequence of independent identically distributed  $m \times 1$  random matrices (vectors) with

$$E(W_k) = \mu \quad \text{and} \quad \text{Var}(W_k) = \Sigma \quad \text{for } k = 1, 2, 3, \dots,$$

where  $\Sigma$  is finite and positive definite.

Let

$$\bar{W}_n \doteq \frac{1}{n} \sum_{k=1}^n W_k$$

then

$$\sqrt{n}(\bar{W}_n - \mu) \xrightarrow{D} N(0, \Sigma).$$

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# Asymptotic Normality of OLS Estimator in Multivariate Regression

Thm.

Given Multivariate Linear Regression Econometric model,

$\mathbf{Y} = \mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\beta} + \mathbf{u}$  with no *multicollinearity*, where

$$\mathbf{Y} = \begin{bmatrix} Y_1 \\ Y_2 \\ \vdots \\ Y_n \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{u} = \begin{bmatrix} u_1 \\ u_2 \\ \vdots \\ u_n \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{X} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & X_{11} & X_{12} & \dots & X_{1k} \\ 1 & X_{21} & X_{22} & \dots & X_{2k} \\ \vdots & & & \ddots & \\ 1 & X_{n1} & X_{n2} & \dots & X_{nk} \end{bmatrix}, \quad \text{and } \boldsymbol{\beta} = \begin{bmatrix} \beta_0 \\ \beta_1 \\ \vdots \\ \beta_k \end{bmatrix},$$

as  $n \rightarrow \infty$ , we have:

$$\sqrt{n}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} - \boldsymbol{\beta}) \xrightarrow{D} N(0, \Sigma_{\sqrt{n}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} - \boldsymbol{\beta})}), \quad \text{where } \Sigma_{\sqrt{n}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} - \boldsymbol{\beta})} = \mathbf{Q}_X^{-1} \Sigma_V \mathbf{Q}_X^{-1},$$

where  $\mathbf{Q}_X = E[X_i X_i^\top]$  and  $\Sigma_V = E[V_i V_i^\top]$  for  $V_i \doteq X_i u_i$ .

Here,  $X_i = (1 \ X_{i1} \ \dots \ X_{ik})^\top$  is the  $i^{\text{th}}$  observation.

# Heteroskedasticity-robust Standard Errors

In order to get  $SE(\hat{\beta}_j)$ , we need to estimate diagonal elements of  $\Sigma_{\sqrt{n}(\hat{\beta}-\beta)}$  via estimating matrices  $Q_X$  and  $\Sigma_V$ :

$$\hat{\Sigma}_{\sqrt{n}(\hat{\beta}-\beta)} = \left( \frac{\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}}{n} \right)^{-1} \hat{\Sigma}_V \left( \frac{\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}}{n} \right)^{-1},$$

where

$$\hat{\Sigma}_V = \frac{1}{n-k-1} \sum_{i=1}^n X_i X_i^\top \hat{u}_i^2.$$

Then

$$SE(\hat{\beta}_j) = \sqrt{\left( \hat{\Sigma}_{\hat{\beta}} \right)_{jj}}, \quad \text{where } \hat{\Sigma}_{\hat{\beta}} = n^{-1} \hat{\Sigma}_{\sqrt{n}(\hat{\beta}-\beta)}.$$

# Confidence Intervals for Predicted Effects

Let  $\mathbf{d}$  be  $(k + 1) \times 1$  matrix. Assume we want to obtain a confidence interval for  $\mathbf{d}^\top \boldsymbol{\beta}$ , then

$$\sqrt{n}(\mathbf{d}^\top \hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} - \mathbf{d}^\top \boldsymbol{\beta}) = \mathbf{d}^\top \sqrt{n}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} - \boldsymbol{\beta}) \xrightarrow{D} N(0, \mathbf{d}^\top \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\sqrt{n}(\hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} - \boldsymbol{\beta})} \mathbf{d})$$

and therefore

$$\mathbf{d}^\top \boldsymbol{\beta} = \mathbf{d}^\top \hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} \pm z_{\alpha/2} \sqrt{\mathbf{d}^\top \hat{\boldsymbol{\Sigma}}_{\hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}}} \mathbf{d}} \text{ with } (1 - \alpha)100\% \text{ confidence.}$$



# Joint Hypotheses

Let  $\mathbf{R}$  be  $q \times (k + 1)$  matrix. Assume we want to test

$$H_0 : \mathbf{R}\boldsymbol{\beta} = \mathbf{r} \text{ vs. } H_1 : \mathbf{R}\boldsymbol{\beta} \neq \mathbf{r}$$

for some  $q \times 1$  vector  $\mathbf{r}$ , then one can use the following TS:

$$\text{TS} = (\mathbf{R}\hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} - \mathbf{r})^\top [\mathbf{R}\hat{\boldsymbol{\Sigma}}_{\hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}}}\mathbf{R}^\top]^{-1}(\mathbf{R}\hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} - \mathbf{r})/q,$$

which approximately follows F-distribution for large  $n$ :

$$\text{TS} \xrightarrow{D} F_{q,\infty}.$$

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# Nonlinear Regression Functions: Linear in Parameters

## Assumptions:

We assume that  $X_{i1}, X_{i2}, \dots, X_{ik}$  and  $Y_i$  are random and there is relation

$$Y_i = f(X_{i1}, X_{i2}, \dots, X_{ik}) + u_i,$$

where

- 1  $f$  is linear in coefficients, i.e.

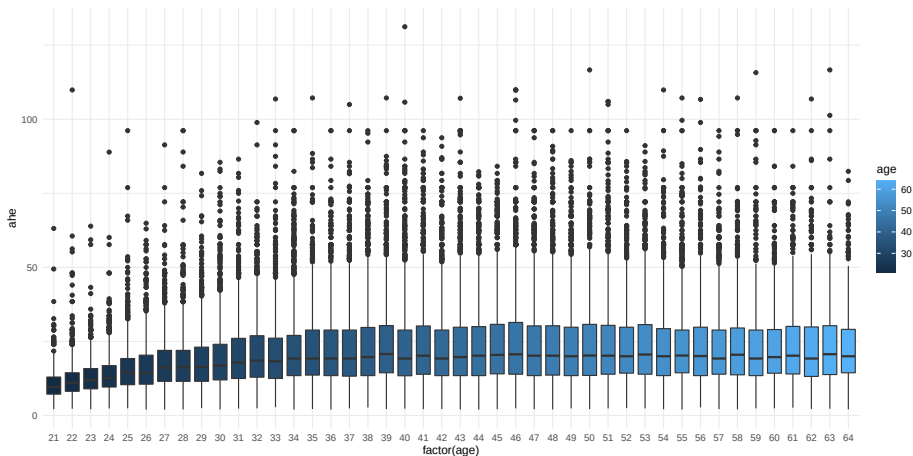
$$f(X_{i1}, X_{i2}, \dots, X_{ik}) = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \underbrace{f_1(X_{i1}, \dots, X_{ik})}_{\text{1st regressor}} + \dots + \beta_K \underbrace{f_K(X_{i1}, \dots, X_{ik})}_{\text{Kth regressor}},$$

where  $f_1, \dots, f_K$  are independent of  $\beta_0, \beta_1, \dots, \beta_K$

- 2 *exogeneity* assumption:  $E[u_i | f_1(X_{i1}, \dots, X_{ik}), \dots, f_K(X_{i1}, \dots, X_{ik})] = 0$
- 3  $(X_{i1}, X_{i2}, \dots, X_{ik}, Y_i)$  is i.i.d. sample drawn from a joint distribution
- 4  $E[f_1^4(X_{i1}, \dots, X_{ik})], \dots, E[f_K^4(X_{i1}, \dots, X_{ik})]$  and  $E[Y_i^4]$  are nonzero and finite
- 5 there is no *multicollinearity* among  $1, f_1(X_{i1}, \dots, X_{ik}), \dots, f_K(X_{i1}, \dots, X_{ik})$

# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 1: Quadratic Regression



# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 1: Quadratic Regression

$$ahe_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \underbrace{age_i}_{f_1(age_i)} + \beta_2 \underbrace{age_i^2}_{f_2(age_i)} + u_i$$

Call:

```
lm(formula = ahe ~ age + I(age^2), data = df)
```

Coefficients:

|             | Estimate   | Std. Error | t value | Pr(> t )   |
|-------------|------------|------------|---------|------------|
| (Intercept) | -1.073e+01 | 7.406e-01  | -14.48  | <2e-16 *** |
| age         | 1.431e+00  | 3.674e-02  | 38.95   | <2e-16 *** |
| I(age^2)    | -1.449e-02 | 4.351e-04  | -33.31  | <2e-16 *** |

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Signif. codes: 0 '\*\*\*' 0.001 '\*\*' 0.01 '\*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

Residual standard error: 13.28 on 63192 degrees of freedom

Multiple R-squared: 0.04724, Adjusted R-squared: 0.04721

F-statistic: 1566 on 2 and 63192 DF, p-value: < 2.2e-16

# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 1: Quadratic Regression

$$\text{ahe}_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \underbrace{\text{age}_i}_{f_1(\text{age}_i)} + \beta_2 \underbrace{\text{age}_i^2}_{f_2(\text{age}_i)} + u_i$$

According to this model, if  $\text{age}_i = a$  and  $\Delta \text{age}_i = 1$ , the expected change in average hourly earnings is

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta \widehat{\text{ahe}}_i &= \left( \hat{\beta}_0 + \hat{\beta}_1 \text{age}_i + \hat{\beta}_2 \text{age}_i^2 \right) \Big|_{\text{age}_i=a+1} - \left( \hat{\beta}_0 + \hat{\beta}_1 \text{age}_i + \hat{\beta}_2 \text{age}_i^2 \right) \Big|_{\text{age}_i=a} \\ &= \hat{\beta}_1 ((a+1) - a) + \hat{\beta}_2 ((a+1)^2 - a^2) \\ &= \hat{\beta}_1 + \hat{\beta}_2 (2a + 1)\end{aligned}$$

# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 1: Quadratic Regression

How can one obtain the standard error of the estimated change

$$\Delta \widehat{a} e_i = \hat{\beta}_1 + \hat{\beta}_2 (2a + 1)?$$

# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 1: Quadratic Regression

How can one obtain the standard error of the estimated change

$$\Delta \widehat{\text{ahe}}_i = \hat{\beta}_1 + \hat{\beta}_2 (2a + 1)?$$

- Method 1: We can re-write the model as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{ahe}_i &= \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{age}_i + \beta_2 \text{age}_i^2 + u_i \\ &= \beta_0 + \underbrace{(\beta_1 + \beta_2 (2a + 1))}_{\text{slope of interest}} \text{age}_i + \beta_2 (\text{age}_i^2 - (2a + 1)\text{age}_i) + u_i \end{aligned}$$

and re-run the regression model on  $\text{age}_i$  and  $(\text{age}_i^2 - (2a + 1)\text{age}_i)$  regressors to get  $\text{SE}(\Delta \widehat{\text{ahe}}_i)$ .



# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 1: Quadratic Regression

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and re-run the regression model on  $\text{age}_i$  and  $(\text{age}_i^2 - (2a + 1)\text{age}_i)$  regressors to get  $\text{SE}(\Delta \widehat{\text{ahe}}_i)$ .

- Method 2: Based on  $F$ -statistic for  $H_0 : \beta_1 + \beta_2 (2a + 1) = 0$  vs.  $H_1 : \beta_1 + \beta_2 (2a + 1) \neq 0$  we get  $\text{SE}(\Delta \widehat{\text{ahe}}_i) = |\Delta \widehat{\text{ahe}}_i| / \sqrt{F}$ .

Note:

$$F = t^2 = \left[ (\hat{\beta}_1 + \hat{\beta}_2 (2a + 1)) / \text{SE}(\hat{\beta}_1 + \hat{\beta}_2 (2a + 1)) \right]^2 = \left[ \Delta \widehat{\text{ahe}}_i / \text{SE}(\Delta \widehat{\text{ahe}}_i) \right]^2.$$

# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 2: Polynomial Regression

$$ahe_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \underbrace{age_i}_{f_1(age_i)} + \beta_2 \underbrace{age_i^2}_{f_2(age_i)} + \beta_3 \underbrace{age_i^3}_{f_3(age_i)} + \beta_4 \underbrace{age_i^4}_{f_4(age_i)} + u_i$$

Call:

```
lm(formula = ahe ~ age + I(age^2) + I(age^3) + I(age^4), data = df)
```

Coefficients:

|             | Estimate   | Std. Error | t value | Pr(> t ) |     |
|-------------|------------|------------|---------|----------|-----|
| (Intercept) | -4.732e+01 | 9.353e+00  | -5.059  | 4.22e-07 | *** |
| age         | 4.363e+00  | 9.752e-01  | 4.474   | 7.69e-06 | *** |
| I(age^2)    | -9.001e-02 | 3.680e-02  | -2.446  | 0.0145   | *   |
| I(age^3)    | 6.607e-04  | 5.974e-04  | 1.106   | 0.2688   |     |
| I(age^4)    | -7.285e-07 | 3.530e-06  | -0.206  | 0.8365   |     |

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Signif. codes: 0 '\*\*\*' 0.001 '\*\*' 0.01 '\*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

Residual standard error: 13.26 on 63190 degrees of freedom

Multiple R-squared: 0.05006, Adjusted R-squared: 0.05

F-statistic: 832.5 on 4 and 63190 DF, p-value: < 2.2e-16

# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 2: Polynomial Regression

```
fit1 <- lm(ahe ~ age, data = df)
fit2 <- lm(ahe ~ age + I(age^2), data = df)
fit3 <- lm(ahe ~ age + I(age^2) + I(age^3), data = df)
fit4 <- lm(ahe ~ age + I(age^2) + I(age^3) + I(age^4), data = df)

library(stargazer)
stargazer(fit1, fit2, fit4, type = "text")
```

# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 2: Polynomial Regression

| Dependent variable:               |                              |                              |                            |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------|
|                                   | (1)                          | ahe<br>(2)                   | (3)                        |
| age                               | 0.218***<br>(0.005)          | 1.431***<br>(0.037)          | 4.363***<br>(0.975)        |
| I(age2)                           |                              | -0.014***<br>(0.0004)        | -0.090**<br>(0.037)        |
| I(age3)                           |                              |                              | 0.001<br>(0.001)           |
| I(age4)                           |                              |                              | -0.00000<br>(0.00000)      |
| Constant                          | 12.934***<br>(0.211)         | -10.725***<br>(0.741)        | -47.321***<br>(9.353)      |
| Observations                      | 63,195                       | 63,195                       | 63,195                     |
| R2                                | 0.031                        | 0.047                        | 0.050                      |
| Adjusted R2                       | 0.030                        | 0.047                        | 0.050                      |
| Residual Std. Error               | 13.393 (df = 63193)          | 13.277 (df = 63192)          | 13.257 (df = 63190)        |
| F Statistic                       | 1,988.816*** (df = 1; 63193) | 1,566.481*** (df = 2; 63192) | 832.454*** (df = 4; 63190) |
| Note: *p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01 |                              |                              |                            |

# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 3: Logarithms

$$ahe_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \underbrace{\ln(\text{age}_i)}_{f_1(\text{age}_i)} + u_i$$

Call:

```
lm(formula = ahe ~ log(age), data = df)
```

Coefficients:

|             | Estimate | Std. Error | t value | Pr(> t )   |
|-------------|----------|------------|---------|------------|
| (Intercept) | -12.8808 | 0.7115     | -18.11  | <2e-16 *** |
| log(age)    | 9.4480   | 0.1919     | 49.23   | <2e-16 *** |

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Signif. codes: 0 '\*\*\*' 0.001 '\*\*' 0.01 '\*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

Residual standard error: 13.35 on 63193 degrees of freedom

Multiple R-squared: 0.03693, Adjusted R-squared: 0.03692

F-statistic: 2423 on 1 and 63193 DF, p-value: < 2.2e-16

# Examples: Quadratic Regression, Polynomials, Logarithms

## Example 4: Nonlinear Controls

```
fit1 <- lm(ahe ~ yrseduc, data = df)
fit2 <- lm(ahe ~ yrseduc + female + northeast + midwest + south + age, data = df)
fit3 <- lm(ahe ~ yrseduc + female + northeast + midwest + south + age + I(age^2), data = df)

library(stargazer)
stargazer(fit1, fit2, fit3, type = "text")
```

## Dependent variable:

|                     | (1)                           | ahe<br>(2)                   | (3)                          |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
| yrseduc             | 2.383***<br>(0.019)           | 2.392***<br>(0.018)          | 2.364***<br>(0.018)          |
| female              |                               | -5.710***<br>(0.093)         | -5.685***<br>(0.093)         |
| northeast           |                               | 0.420***<br>(0.139)          | 0.347**<br>(0.138)           |
| midwest             |                               | -1.917***<br>(0.133)         | -1.987***<br>(0.132)         |
| south               |                               | -1.346***<br>(0.124)         | -1.375***<br>(0.123)         |
| age                 |                               | 0.192***<br>(0.004)          | 1.192***<br>(0.032)          |
| I(age2)             |                               |                              | -0.012***<br>(0.0004)        |
| Constant            | -11.083***<br>(0.270)         | -15.906***<br>(0.315)        | -35.004***<br>(0.682)        |
| Observations        | 63,195                        | 63,195                       | 63,195                       |
| R2                  | 0.197                         | 0.268                        | 0.280                        |
| Adjusted R2         | 0.197                         | 0.268                        | 0.280                        |
| Residual Std. Error | 12.188 (df = 63193)           | 11.634 (df = 63188)          | 11.544 (df = 63187)          |
| F Statistic         | 15,510.130*** (df = 1; 63193) | 3,864.908*** (df = 6; 63188) | 3,506.820*** (df = 7; 63187) |

# Interactions

Interactions between independent variables:

- Two binary variables:

$$Y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 D_{i1} + \beta_2 D_{i2} + \beta_3 \underbrace{(D_{i1} \times D_{i2})}_{\text{interaction term}} + u_i$$

- Continuous and binary variables:

$$Y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X_i + \beta_2 D_i + \beta_3 \underbrace{(X_i \times D_i)}_{\text{interaction term}} + u_i$$

- Two continuous variables:

$$Y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X_{i1} + \beta_2 X_{i2} + \beta_3 \underbrace{(X_{i1} \times X_{i2})}_{\text{interaction term}} + u_i$$